

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday September 19, 2019

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #14, September 19, 2019

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom) beginning at 16:00 UTC

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (10/11): Francesco Cesarini, Benoît Chesneau, Maxim Fedorov, Kenneth Lundin, Miriam Pena Villanueva, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, José Valim, Alistair Woodman.

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #13 held on September 5, 2019.

2. Intermediate actions:

1. Alistair will have a review with the foundation group next week
3. Treasury update: Approximately \$70k in the bank. We have two new sponsors PepsiCo and DockYard (both at \$10K) coming onboard.
4. Membership update: We are now a total of 359 members (70 annual supporting, 4, lifetime members, 277 basic members, and 8 board members).
5. Peer presented the proposal for forming an Embedded Working Group.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the establishment of the “Embedded” working group with the proposal which is inserted with the minutes of this meeting. Peer will report back to the board the initial chair person of the working group once it has formed.

6. Licensing discussion for IP developed using grants needs to happen at board level, but the question was tabled for this meeting.

7. Grant Process as a whole: Miriam shared current status (current wording sent out to board on mailing list, and is up on website) --- presented the current process from the website. A discussion around the process, and how to do approval was held, especially in regard how to sponsor development work, as well as what grants should go through working groups, and if there is need for a “grant proposal working group”. Alistair and Miriam will work on a place to summarize current proposals and present at future board meeting (Kenneth, Peer, José also volunteered)

The meeting was adjourned at 17:10 UTC.

Dated September 19, 2019

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Latest change: 9 September 2019

Working Group Name

Embedded Systems Working Group

Mission Statement

Standardize, improve, and promote the APIs, tooling, and infrastructure for building embedded systems and IoT devices using Erlang VMs

Benefits to the community

- Better collaboration among the embedded systems projects in the community
- Central location for funding of projects of common benefit to embedded systems
- Growth of the community not only due to better software, but due to improving the perception of BEAM languages and the Erlang VM as mature and long-term viable platforms for embedded systems projects

Short term deliverables

We need to get the word out among embedded systems designers in the BEAM community that this working group exists. There are a lot of areas that the working group could address. A first deliverables would be to survey embedded systems developers in the BEAM community to identify needs so that the working group can focus their efforts. Completing this survey need not delay funding of embedded systems working group grant proposals of common interest.

Long term deliverables

Possible long term deliverables include:

- Standardized firmware update mechanisms and formats
- Extensions or other means of addressing hard real-time with Erlang VMs
- Open-source implementations for protocols commonly used in embedded systems project
- Improvements to the Erlang VM or additional libraries in support of IoT security

Why does this group require the Foundation

The embedded systems and IoT space is larger than any one project can address. Having a working group to align common concerns across embedded projects in BEAM languages will

increase the quality of existing solutions and enable us to push forward in areas where we're deficient.

Additionally, the long life cycles of commercial embedded devices requires companies to evaluate the long-term viability of their software stacks. The Erlang Ecosystem and an active embedded systems working group provide this assurance for the BEAM and the embedded use case in a way that can outlast the current set of individuals, companies and consultancies involved with embedded Erlang and Elixir.

Initial list of volunteers

Adam Lindberg
Frank Hunleth
Justin Schneck
Peer Stritzinger
Hideki Takase